CISO Portfolio Case Study

Engineering Enterprise Resilience: A 180-Day Security Posture Evolution

Transforming risk management for a Leading Microfinance Institution.

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The Mandate: From Reactive Chaos to Engineered Control

Month 0: High Risk

- Ad-hoc Vulnerability Management
- Fragmented, limited endpoint security
- Zero centralized threat detection
- Reactive cloud posture

Month 6: The Target State

- Continuous DevSecOps integration
- Hardened, managed endpoints
- Centralized, 24/7 SIEM monitoring
- Proactive, monitored cloud infrastructure

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Quantifying the Baseline Enterprise Risk

Operational Risk

Metric: Unmeasured Dwell Time

Inability to detect lateral movement across unsegmented networks, threatening business continuity.

Financial Risk

Metric: Exposed Critical Critical Assets

Unmanaged endpoints and zero continuous scanning elevated the probability of ransomware and catastrophic downtime.

Regulatory Risk

Metric: Low Governance Maturity

Lack of formalized access controls and audit trails endangered banking compliance and client trust.

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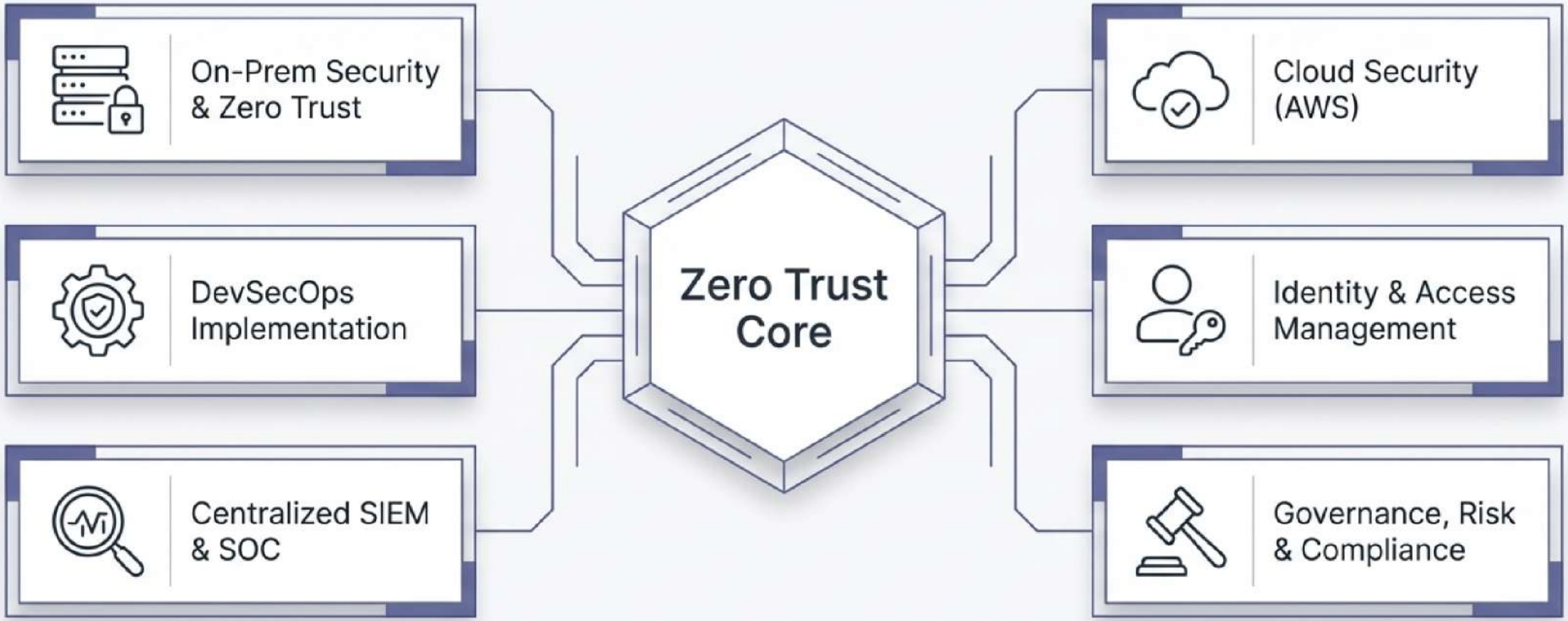
The Zero Trust Transformation Blueprint

Architected a resilient, multi-layered security stack organized into six parallel, mutually reinforcing workstreams.



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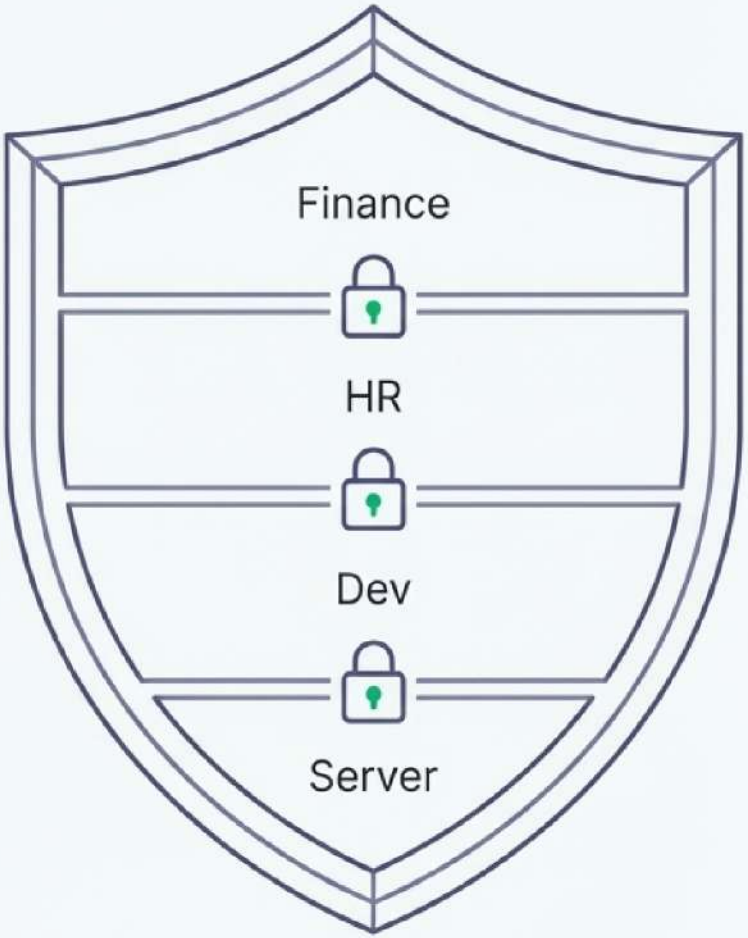
Fortifying the Foundation with Micro-Segmentation

Shifted perimeter defense to proactive, identity-aware Zero Trust using FortiGate and ManageEngine.

Architected strict departmental VLAN segmentation (Finance, HR, Dev, Server) with least-privilege inter-VLAN ACLs.

Deployed FortiGate 70F Next-Generation Firewalls to govern edge and internal traffic.

Hardened 100% of endpoints via ManageEngine Endpoint Central, enforcing rigorous AV baselines and rapid patching.



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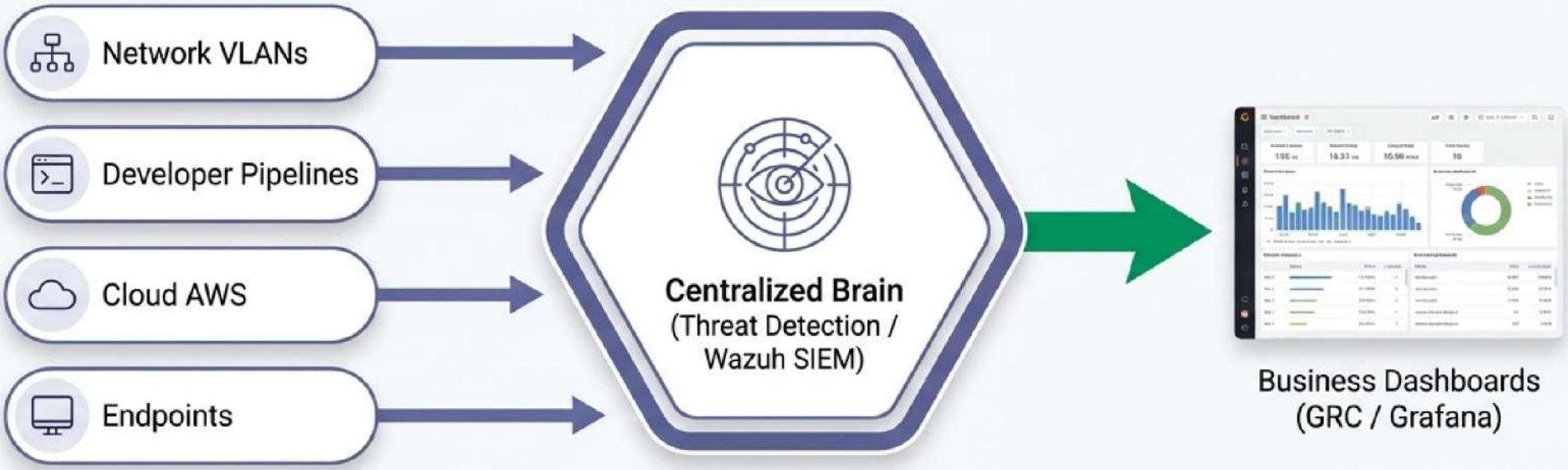
Illuminating Dark Data via Centralized Telemetry

Unified disparate log sources into a single pane of glass, dramatically accelerating threat response.

Telemetry Funnel



- Orchestrated Wazuh SIEM deployment, aggregating feeds from FortiGate, AWS CloudWatch, and **Suricata IPS/IDS**
- Engineered threat detection logic mapped directly to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Result: **Slashed Mean Time To Detect (MTTD) to under 15 minutes.**

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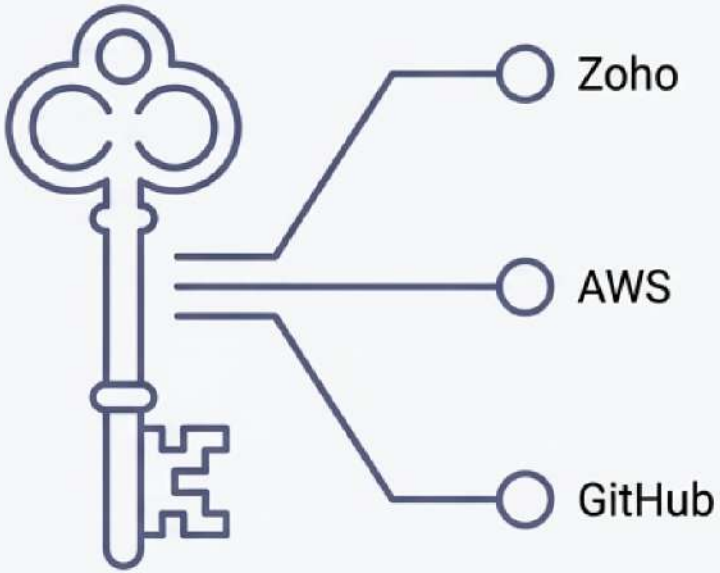
Identity as the New Perimeter

Secured user identities with centralized authentication and universal multi-factor protection across all hybrid environments.



Federated 100% of critical applications with a centralized Identity Provider (IdP).

Streamlined secure access across Zoho, AWS, and GitHub via Single Sign-On (SSO).

KPI Scorecard

100%

MFA coverage achieved across all users.

0

inactive privileged users remaining after 30-day sweeps.

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The 180-Day Execution Sprint

Aggressively delivered a multi-layered enterprise security stack without disrupting core banking operations

Month 1-2	Month 2-3	Month 3-4	Month 4-5	Month 5-6
Security governance and policy framework established.	Endpoint visibility and asset discovery achieved.	Continuous vulnerability management deployed.	DevSecOps pipeline integration completed.	Centralized threat detection (SOC) operationalized.

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The Executive Telemetry Dashboard

Replaced anecdotal security assumptions with verifiable, continuous operational metrics.

Patch Compliance

Target ≥95% | Actual ≥95%

Firewall Rule Review

Target 100% | Actual 100%

Cloud Monitoring

Target 100% | Actual 100%

SOC MTTD / MTTR

Target <15m / <1h | Actual <15m / <1h

Builds Passing Security

Target ≥95% | Actual ≥95%

MFA Coverage

Target 100% | Actual 100%

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Orchestrating a Culture of Continuous Security

Embedded security into the organizational DNA through a predictable, collaborative cadence rather than functioning as a “Department of No.”

Rhythm of Operations

Daily
(Triage)

- Real-time SIEM alerts.
- AWS GuardDuty monitoring.
- Endpoint compliance tracking.

Weekly
(Proactive)

- Firewall policy reviews.
- Patch exception management.
- IAM audits.

Monthly
(Strategic)

- Formal IR drills.
- Vulnerability reporting.
- Board-level KPI reviews.

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Engineering Regulatory Resilience

Transformed compliance from a reactive scramble into a state of continuous audit readiness, safeguarding the institution's operating licenses.

ISO 27001

CBN

PCI DSS

NDPR

1

Operationalized a Cybersecurity Governance Board managing a dynamic, weekly risk register.

2

Mapped technical controls directly to ISO 27001, CBN, PCI DSS, and NDPR requirements.

3

Achieved and maintained an Audit Readiness Score of

≥ 90%,

with 100% of critical risks mitigated within defined SLAs.

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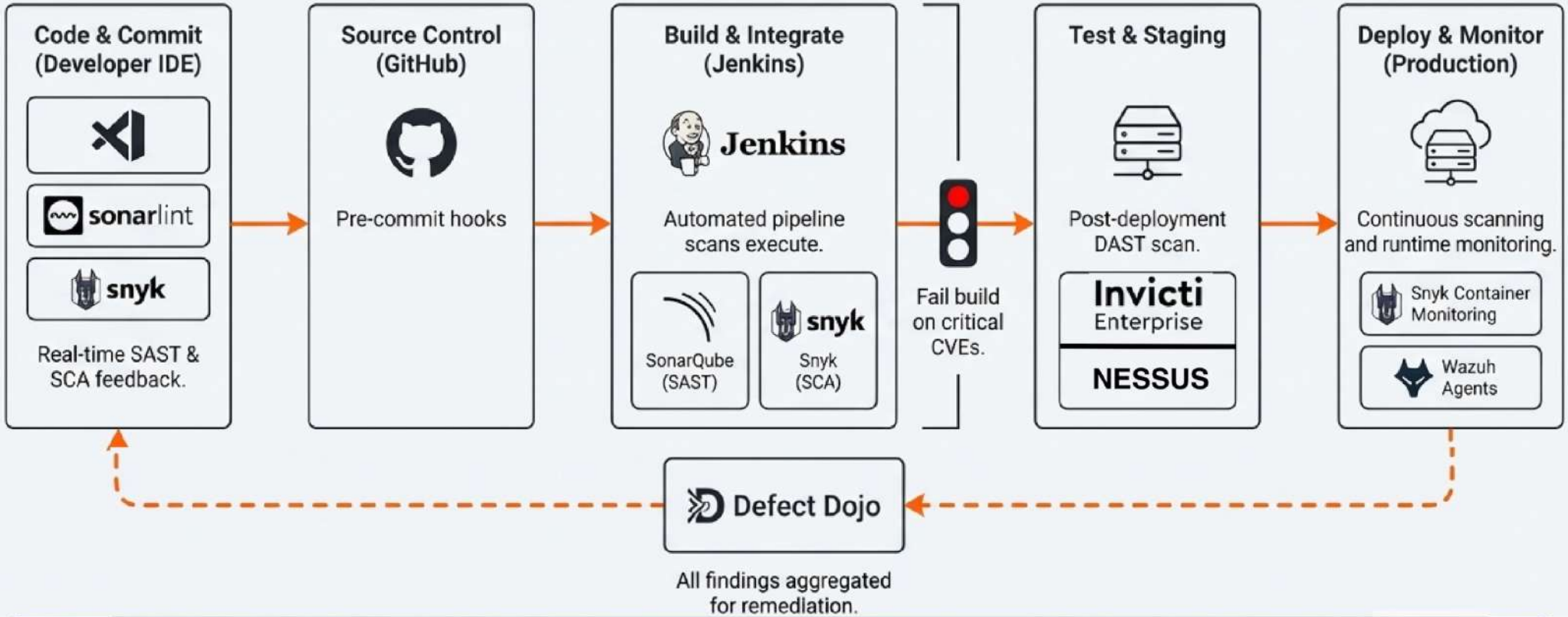
The DevSecOps Blueprint: A Continuous Security Pipeline



- **The Threat:** High-velocity code deployments bypassing security validation.
- **The Result:** Zero critical vulnerabilities deployed to production.

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The Business Return on Security Investment

This 6-month transformation fundamentally de-risked operations, ensuring the financial safety of the institution and its clients.

Guaranteed Uptime

Cloud infrastructure hardened - (**0 unencrypted S3 buckets, 0 root-user API calls**), **ensuring platform availability**.

Brand Protection

Eliminated critical CVE exposure in production, **safeguarding client trust**.

Capital Efficiency

Rationalized open-source and commercial tooling (Wazuh, DefectDojo) to **maximize security capability without bloated software spend**.

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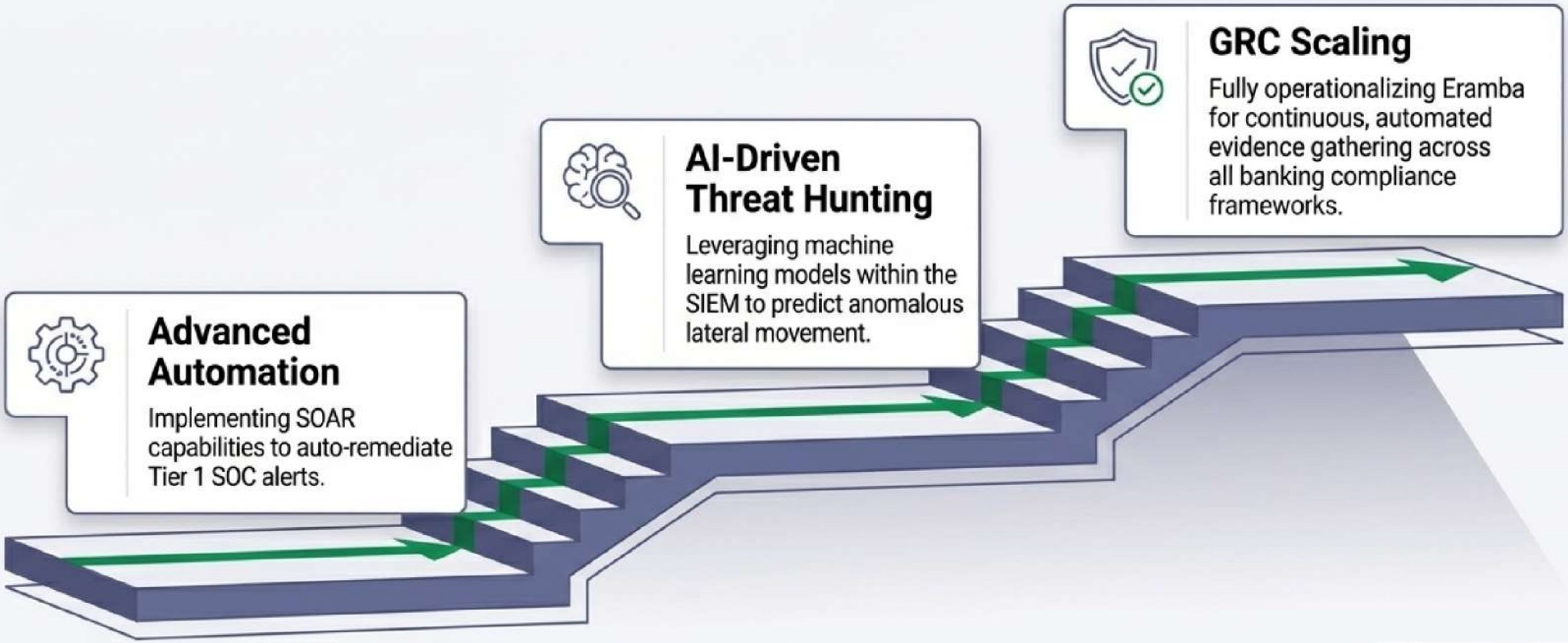
The Strategic Horizon: Phase 2

The **resilient foundation** is built. The next 12-24 months will focus on **automation, AI-driven threat hunting**, and **dynamic scale**.



The Transformation Toolkit

Strategic vision executed through deep, hands-on domain mastery across network, cloud, and application security stacks.

Network & Endpoint	Cloud & Telemetry	DevSecOps	Identity & GRC
FortiGate 70F	AWS (CloudTrail, WAF, GuardDuty)	Snyk & SonarQube	Eramba
ManageEngine	Wazuh SIEM	Invicti	CISO Assistant
Nessus	Grafana	Jenkins & GitHub Actions	SSO/IdP
		DefectDojo	